

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

High School Foundations | Unit 6

Suffix -ative



Today I am learning that the suffix -ative often forms adjectives describing a quality, tendency or function.

1 Learn the Meaning

The suffix -ative often forms adjectives that describe a quality, tendency or function. It is common in academic and formal vocabulary. Use the base or related word to work out how the derived adjective adds meaning.

talkative

tending to talk

argumentative

inclined to argue

informative

giving information

consultative

involving consultation

2 Build the Word

Add -ative to the base or related word. Build the new word, then write a short meaning clue.

Base / related	Add	New word	Meaning clue
talk	-ative		
inform	-ative		
argument	-ative		
consult	-ative		
prevent	-ative		

3 Read and Notice

At a youth media forum, students reviewed how information is presented to an audience. The opening session was informative, giving clear examples of how evidence can strengthen a claim. During a consultative discussion, each group was asked to listen to different viewpoints before making a recommendation. One student was especially talkative, but the facilitator reminded everyone to share the speaking time.

The next activity focused on debate. A useful argument can challenge an idea, but an argumentative tone can make discussion less productive. Students compared calm, evidence-based responses with comments that sounded argumentative. They also examined a preventative communication plan designed to reduce misunderstandings before they became larger problems.

To finish, the class wrote an interpretative note explaining how word structure helped them understand unfamiliar adjectives. They noticed that words ending in -ative often described a tendency, quality or function. Linking each word to a base or related word - such as talk, inform, argument, consult or prevent - gave them a stronger clue to meaning than simply memorising the spelling.



Highlight the -ative words. Underline a base or related word clue when you can, then explain what quality, tendency or function each adjective describes.

4 Word Detective

Choose one -ative word from the passage and investigate its structure, related words and meaning.

a

Write an -ative word from the passage.

b

What base or related word can you identify?

c

What quality, tendency or function does it describe?

d

Explain how -ative contributes to the whole-word meaning.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the -ative adjectives by the kind of meaning they express.

talkative

argumentative

informative

consultative

preventative

interpretative

Tendency / behaviour

Purpose / function

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

a

An informative explanation should

b

Use one -ative adjective in a sentence and explain its base or related word.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises -ative in derived adjectives
- ☐ Identifies a base or related word
- ☐ Explains quality, tendency or function
- ☐ Uses derived adjectives accurately in context



Capture idea:

Find an -ative adjective in a book, article or website. Record the word, identify a base or related word, and explain what quality, tendency or function it describes.